

Word family: **keep / keeps / kept / keeping / keeper**

Base word: keep

Third-person singular: keeps

Past tense: kept

Past participle: kept

-ing form: keeping

Related forms: keeper

Useful constructions/extensions: keep doing, keep + adjective, keep something + adjective, keep something, keep a record, keep a promise, keep a secret, keep someone waiting, keep someone from doing something, keep away, keep calm, keep in touch, keep track of, keep an eye on, keep to a schedule, keep someone company, keep your word, for keeps, keeper

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / related noun forms (相關名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “I knew this was the kind of opportunity I could not **keep avoiding**.”

and later:

> “I did make a couple of small mistakes, but I **kept going** instead of freezing.”

So the passage itself already contains the same core **continuation** meaning twice:

> **keep avoiding**

> = 一直逃避 / 繼續逃避

> **keep going**

> = 繼續下去

Meaning in this passage

In:

> “I could not **keep avoiding** [this kind of opportunity].”

keep means:

to continue doing the same action repeatedly or over a period of time.

You knew that you could not continue responding to difficult public-speaking opportunities by avoiding them again and again.

Meaning: To continue doing something without stopping or changing the behaviour.

****繁體中文： ** 持續 / 一直做某件事，尤其指某個行為反覆延續下去****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “I knew this was the kind of opportunity I could not keep avoiding.”

「我知道這種機會是我**不能一直逃避下去的**。」

And later:

> “I kept going instead of freezing.”

「我沒有僵住，而是**繼續講下去**。」

So:

****keep + -ing = 持續 / 一直做某事****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****keep + -ing (持續做某事) — 繼續；一直****

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To continue doing an action repeatedly or without stopping.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I knew this was the kind of opportunity I could not ****keep avoiding****.”

「我知道這種機會是我**不能一直逃避下去的**。」

Practice 2 — Original

> “I ****kept going**** instead of freezing.”

「我沒有僵住，而是**繼續下去 / 繼續講下去**。」

Practice 3

> “She ****kept practising**** until she felt more confident.”

「她**一直練習**，直到自己更有信心。」

****keep + -ing = 某個動作持續、反覆或不停止地進行****

Common:

- * keep trying
- * keep working
- * keep talking
- * keep practising
- * keep going

2. ****keep on + -ing (繼續不斷做) — 一直；不停地****

A closely related construction.

Practice 4

> “He ****kept on asking**** the same question.”

「他****不停地問****同一個問題。」

Practice 5

> “She ****kept on practising**** even after everyone else had left.”

「其他人離開後，她仍然****繼續練習****。」

****keep on doing = 持續 / 反覆做某事，常帶「一直不停」的語感****

This is very close to ordinary ****keep doing****.

3. ****keep going (繼續下去) — 繼續；撐下去****

A particularly important fixed construction for your passage.

Practice 6 — Original

> “I made a couple of small mistakes, but I ****kept going****.”

「我犯了幾個小錯，但仍然****繼續講下去****。」

Practice 7

> “Even if you lose your place, just **keep going**.”

「即使你一時找不到講到哪裡，也只管**繼續下去**。」

keep going = 即使有困難、疲勞或中斷風險，也繼續進行

This can describe:

- * speaking;
- * walking;
- * working;
- * surviving through difficulty.

4. **keep** = retain / continue to have (保留) — 保留；留下

A major separate core meaning.

Meaning: To continue possessing something instead of giving, throwing, returning, or losing it.

Practice 8

> “You can **keep** the notes.”

「你可以**保留這些筆記**。」

Practice 9

> “She decided to **keep** the old laptop.”

「她決定**留下那部舊手提電腦**。」

keep something = 繼續擁有某物，不把它交走、丟掉或放棄

5. **keep** = not return something (留下不用歸還) — 留著；不用還

Practice 10

> “You can **keep** the copy.”

「這份副本你可以**留著，不用歸還**。」

Practice 11

> “The restaurant said we could **keep the menu**.”

「餐廳說我們可以把餐牌**留下**。」

keep something = 不需要把某物交還給原來的人 / 地方

6. **keep** = store / put somewhere for later (存放) — 保存 ; 存放

A common storage meaning.

Practice 12

> “I **keep my presentation files** on the cloud.”

「我把簡報檔案**存放在雲端**。」

Practice 13

> “Where do you **keep** the spare batteries?”

「你把後備電池**放在哪裡 / 存放在哪裡**？」

keep something somewhere = 把某物放在某處保存，以便之後使用

7. **keep food/drink** (保存食物) — 保存 ; 保鮮

Practice 14

> “**Keep** the food in the refrigerator.”

「把食物**放在雪櫃保存**。」

Practice 15

> “This sauce will **keep** for several days.”

「這種醬料可以**保存幾天而不變壞**。」

Here we see two perspectives:

* **keep something** = 保存某物

* **something keeps** = 某物能保存一段時間

8. **keep a record/list/diary (保存 / 記錄) — 記錄；保存紀錄**

Practice 16

> “I **keep a record** of all my presentations.”

「我會**記錄**自己所有的簡報。」

Practice 17

> “The company **keeps detailed records** of expenses.”

「公司**保存詳細的開支紀錄**。」

keep a record = 建立並持續保存資料 / 紀錄

9. **keep = maintain in a condition (保持) — 保持；維持**

Another major core meaning.

Practice 18

> “Try to **keep calm**.”

「嘗試**保持冷靜**。」

Practice 19

> “Please **keep quiet** during the presentation.”

「簡報期間請**保持安靜**。」

keep + adjective = 讓自己 / 某物持續保持某種狀態

Common:

* keep calm

* keep quiet

* keep warm

* keep safe
* keep busy

10. **keep something + adjective/state (使某物保持.....) — 使維持某狀態**

Practice 20

> “Keep your explanation **simple**.”

「讓你的解釋**保持簡單**。」

Practice 21

> “The speaker kept the slides **clear and uncluttered**.”

「講者令投影片一直**保持清晰而不雜亂**。」

keep + object + adjective = 使某人 / 某物持續維持指定狀態

This differs from:

> **keep calm**

where the subject itself remains calm.

11. **keep someone interested/awake/busy (令某人持續處於某狀態) — 使一直.....**

Practice 22

> “The examples helped **keep the audience interested**.”

「那些例子令觀眾**一直保持興趣**。」

Practice 23

> “The project **kept us busy** for months.”

「這個項目令我們幾個月都**一直很忙**。」

keep someone + adjective = 使某人持續處於某個狀態

12. **keep something working/running (維持運作) — 維持運作；保持運轉**

Practice 24

> “We need backup power to **keep the equipment running**.”

「我們需要後備電源來**維持設備運作**。」

Practice 25

> “Regular maintenance **keeps the system working**.”

「定期維修可令系統**持續正常運作**。」

keep something running/working = 令系統、機器或活動繼續運作而不中斷

13. **keep = prevent from changing/stopping (維持) — 維持；保持不變**

Practice 26

> “We need to **keep costs low**.”

「我們需要**維持低成本**。」

Practice 27

> “The company wants to **keep prices stable**.”

「公司希望**保持價格穩定**。」

keep something + condition = 防止某事偏離 / 離開目前理想狀態

14. **keep someone waiting (讓某人一直等) — 讓……久等**

A very common causative construction.

Practice 28

> “Sorry to **keep you waiting**.”

「對不起，**讓你久等了**。」

Practice 29

> “The manager **kept us waiting** for twenty minutes.”

「經理**讓我們等了二十分鐘**。」

keep someone doing = 令某人持續進行某個動作 / 處於某個情況

15. **keep someone from doing something** (阻止某人做.....) — 阻止；使不能

A major grammatical construction.

Practice 30

> “Fear should not **keep you from speaking**.”

「恐懼不應該**阻止你發言**。」

Practice 31

> “The technical problem **kept us from starting** on time.”

「技術問題**令我們無法準時開始**。」

keep someone from doing something = 阻止、妨礙某人進行某個動作

This is conceptually very different from **keep doing**.

Compare:

> **keep speaking**

> = 繼續說

> **keep someone from speaking**

> = 阻止某人說

16. **keep something from happening** (防止事情發生) — 防止；避免

Practice 32

> “Preparation can **keep small mistakes from becoming bigger problems**.”

「充分準備可以**防止小錯變成更大的問題**。」

Practice 33

> “The cover **keeps dust from entering** the device.”

「外殼可以**防止灰塵進入**裝置。」

keep something from happening = 防止某件事情發生

17. **keep away from (遠離) — 避開 ; 遠離**

A common phrasal extension.

Practice 34

> “**Keep away from** the edge.”

「**遠離**邊緣。」

Practice 35

> “He tries to **keep away from** unnecessary conflict.”

「他盡量**避免 / 遠離**不必要的衝突。」

keep away from = 不靠近 / 避免接觸某人、某物或某情況

Because this is a phrasal verb, it is a family extension rather than a core bare-**keep** sense.

18. **keep something away (使遠離) — 擋住 ; 使不接近**

Practice 36

> “The screen helps **keep the sunlight away**.”

「這塊屏幕可以幫助**阻擋陽光**。」

Practice 37

> “The treatment helps **keep insects away**.”

「這種處理可以**防止昆蟲靠近**。」

keep something away = 使某物保持在遠處 / 不能接近

19. **keep to + rule/schedule/plan (遵守) — 遵守 ; 按照**

A useful formal/workplace meaning.

Practice 38

> “Try to **keep to the schedule**.”

「盡量**按照時間表進行**。」

Practice 39

> “Please **keep to the rules**.”

「請**遵守規則**。」

keep to something = 按照既定規則、時間、計劃或主題行事，不偏離

20. **keep to the point/topic (不離題) — 緊扣主題**

Practice 40

> “Try to **keep to the point** during the presentation.”

「簡報時盡量**緊扣重點，不要離題**。」

Practice 41

> “Please **keep to the topic**.”

「請**不要離題，緊扣主題**。」

keep to the point/topic = 持續集中在相關內容，不轉到無關事情

21. **keep a promise (守承諾) — 遵守承諾**

A major fixed collocation.

Practice 42

> “She **kept her promise** to help me practise.”

「她**信守承諾**，幫我練習。」

Practice 43

> “You should always **keep your promises**.”

「你應該一直**信守承諾**。」

keep a promise = 按照自己曾答應的事情去做，而不食言

22. **keep your word** (守信) — 信守承諾；說到做到

Practice 44

> “He said he would help, and he **kept his word**.”

「他說會幫忙，而且真的**說到做到 / 信守承諾**。」

Practice 45

> “I trust her because she always **keeps her word**.”

「我信任她，因為她一向都**守信**。」

keep your word = 履行自己已經作出的承諾

23. **keep a secret** (保守秘密) — 保密；守秘密

Practice 46

> “Can you **keep a secret**?”

「你可以**保守秘密**嗎？」

Practice 47

> “She promised to **keep the information secret**.”

「她答應會**把資料保密**。」

keep a secret = 不把秘密內容告訴其他人

Compare:

> **keep a secret**

and:

> **keep something secret**

Both are common.

24. **keep in touch** (保持聯絡) — 保持聯絡

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 48

> “Let’s **keep in touch** after the project ends.”

「項目結束後我們要**保持聯絡**。」

Practice 49

> “I still **keep in touch with** several former colleagues.”

「我仍然和幾位前同事**保持聯絡**。」

keep in touch = 持續與某人聯絡，不因時間 / 距離而失去聯繫

25. **keep track of** (掌握 / 記錄) — 追蹤；掌握

Practice 50

> “I use a timer to **keep track of** my presentation length.”

「我用計時器來**掌握簡報時間**。」

Practice 51

> “It is difficult to **keep track of** all the changes.”

「要**掌握所有改動**並不容易。」

keep track of = 持續知道某人 / 某事的位置、進度、數量或變化

26. **keep an eye on (留意 / 照看) — 留意 ; 監察 ; 看一下**

A common idiom.

Practice 52

> “Could you **keep an eye on** the time for me?”

「你可以幫我**留意一下時間**嗎？」

Practice 53

> “Please **keep an eye on** my bag.”

「請幫我**看一下袋子**。」

keep an eye on = 持續留意、監察或暫時照看某人 / 某物

27. **keep watch (守望 / 監視) — 看守 ; 監察**

Practice 54

> “Someone stayed behind to **keep watch**.”

「有人留下來**看守 / 監察**。」

Practice 55

> “Security staff **kept watch** over the entrance.”

「保安人員一直**監察入口**。」

keep watch = 持續觀察某處 / 某人，以防問題發生

28. **keep someone company (陪伴某人) — 陪伴 ; 作伴**

A highly useful fixed construction.

Practice 56

> “She stayed to **keep me company** before the presentation.”

「簡報前她留下來**陪我 / 給我作伴**。」

Practice 57

> “I’ll **keep you company** while you wait.”

「你等候期間我會**陪你**。」

keep someone company = 留在某人身邊陪伴對方，使其不必獨處

Here **keep** does not mean “retain.”

29. **keep house (料理家務 / 維持家庭) — 料理家務**

A traditional expression.

Practice 58

> “She worked while he **kept house**.”

「她外出工作，而他負責**料理家務**。」

Practice 59

> “They hired someone to help **keep house**.”

「他們聘請了人幫忙**料理家務**。」

keep house = 管理家庭日常事務、清潔、做飯等

This is less central in modern everyday vocabulary but still established.

30. **keep = look after / support animals (飼養) — 飼養**

A distinct meaning.

Practice 60

> “They **keep chickens** in the garden.”

「他們在花園裡**養雞**。」

Practice 61

> “She has always **kept horses**.”

「她一直都有**養馬**。」

keep animals = 長期飼養、照顧某些動物

31. **keep = own/manage a shop/inn (經營 ; 較舊 / 英式) — 經營**

A more traditional sense.

Practice 62

> “His family **kept a small shop**.”

「他的家人**經營一間小店**。」

Practice 63

> “They once **kept an inn** near the station.”

「他們以前曾在車站附近**經營旅店**。」

keep a shop/inn = 經營並管理一間商店 / 旅店

This is established but more traditional than:

> run a shop

32. **keep = support financially (供養) — 供養 ; 維持生活**

A somewhat traditional meaning.

Practice 64

> “His salary was enough to **keep** the family.”

「他的薪金足以**供養全家**。」

Practice 65

> “The farm barely **kept** them.”

「那個農場的收入勉強足以**維持他們的生活**。」

keep someone = 提供某人生活所需要的金錢 / 物資

This is less common than:

> support

in modern everyday English.

33. **keep** = remain fresh/good (保持良好狀態) — 保存良好；不變壞

Practice 66

> “This food will **keep** for three days.”

「這些食物可以**保存三天而不變壞**。」

Practice 67

> “The flowers won’t **keep** long in this heat.”

「這些花在這種高溫下**保存不了多久**。」

something keeps = 某物在一段時間內仍保持良好 / 可使用狀態

34. **keep well** (保存得好 / 健康良好) — 保存良好；身體好

A context-dependent expression.

Food/product:

> “These apples **keep well**.”

「這些蘋果**很耐放**。」

Person:

> “I hope you are **keeping well**.”

「希望你**身體健康 / 近來安好**。」

The second is especially British and somewhat traditional/polite.

35. **keep fit/healthy (保持健康) — 保持健康 / 體能**

Practice 68

> “Regular exercise helps me **keep fit**.”

「定期運動幫助我**保持體能**。」

Practice 69

> “Good sleep helps **keep you healthy**.”

「充足睡眠有助你**保持健康**。」

keep fit/healthy = 持續維持良好的身體狀態

This belongs to the maintain-state meaning.

36. **keep warm/cool/dry (保持溫暖 / 涼爽 / 乾爽) — 保持某身體 / 物理狀態**

Practice 70

> “Wear a jacket to **keep warm**.”

「穿件外套來**保暖**。」

Practice 71

> “This cover will **keep** the equipment dry.”

「這個保護套會令設備**保持乾爽**。」

keep + physical state = 持續維持某種溫度、濕度或環境狀態

37. **keep** = stay/remain somewhere (留在某處；較固定結構) — 留在；待在

Mostly found in constructions rather than freely used as bare **keep**.

Practice 72

> “**Keep behind** the line.”

「請**留在線後**。」

Practice 73

> “Please **keep to the left**.”

「請**靠左行 / 保持在左邊**。」

The broader semantic idea is:

remain in a specified position/course

38. **keep left/right** (靠左 / 右) — 保持靠左 / 靠右

Practice 74

> “Please **keep left** on the escalator.”

「扶手電梯上請**靠左**。」

Practice 75

> “Drivers should **keep right** after the junction.”

「駕駛者過路口後應該**靠右行駛**。」

keep left/right = 持續位於指定方向 / 一側

39. **keep pace with (跟上) — 跟上速度 / 進度**

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 76

> “Technology changes quickly, so companies must **keep pace with** it.”

「科技變化很快，公司必須**跟上其發展步伐**。」

Practice 77

> “I struggled to **keep pace with** the speaker.”

「我很難**跟上講者的速度**。」

keep pace with = 以相同速度 / 進度前進，不被對方拋離

40. **keep up with (跟上) — 跟上；維持同等水平**

A phrasal extension.

Practice 78

> “I practised so I could **keep up with** the discussion.”

「我練習是為了可以**跟上討論**。」

Practice 79

> “It is difficult to **keep up with** all the changes.”

「要**跟上所有變化**並不容易。」

keep up with = 跟上某人的速度、知識、進展或變化

Because this is a phrasal verb, it should be treated as a family extension.

41. **keep your balance (保持平衡) — 保持平衡**

Practice 80

> “She held the rail to **keep her balance**.”

「她扶著欄杆來**保持平衡**。」

Practice 81

> “It was difficult to **keep my balance** on the moving train.”

「在移動中的火車上很難**保持平衡**。」

keep your balance = 防止自己失去平衡 / 跌倒

42. **keep control** (維持控制) — 保持控制 ; 控制住

Practice 82

> “I tried to **keep control of** my breathing.”

「我嘗試**控制好**自己的呼吸。」

Practice 83

> “The manager struggled to **keep control of** the discussion.”

「經理很難**控制住**討論局面。」

keep control of = 持續掌握、管理或控制某個情況

43. **keep order** (維持秩序) — 維持秩序

Practice 84

> “Security staff helped **keep order**.”

「保安人員協助**維持秩序**。」

Practice 85

> “The chairperson tried to **keep order** during the meeting.”

「主席在會議期間嘗試**維持秩序**。」

keep order = 防止混亂，維持有規則、有控制的狀態

44. **keep your cool** (保持冷靜) — 保持冷靜；沉住氣

A common informal idiom.

Practice 86

> “Even after making a mistake, I tried to **keep my cool**.”

「即使犯了錯，我仍努力**保持冷靜 / 沉住氣**。」

Practice 87

> “She **kept her cool** under pressure.”

「她在壓力下仍然**保持冷靜**。」

keep your cool = 在令人緊張、憤怒或有壓力的情況下控制情緒並保持冷靜

45. **keep your head** (保持冷靜) — 冷靜應對；不慌亂

Practice 88

> “The key is to **keep your head** when something goes wrong.”

「出問題時，關鍵是要**保持冷靜、不慌亂**。」

Practice 89

> “She **kept her head** and finished the presentation.”

「她**保持冷靜**並完成了簡報。」

keep your head = 在壓力 / 危險中維持理性和冷靜

46. **keep an open mind** (保持開放態度) — 保持開放心態

Practice 90

> “Try to **keep an open mind** when receiving feedback.”

「接受回饋時要**保持開放態度**。」

Practice 91

> “I decided to **keep an open mind** about the opportunity.”

「我決定對這個機會**保持開放心態**。」

keep an open mind = 暫不過早下結論，願意考慮不同可能性 / 觀點

47. **keep someone informed** (讓某人持續知情) — 隨時通知；讓.....掌握情況

Practice 92

> “Please **keep me informed** about any changes.”

「如有任何改動，請**隨時通知我 / 讓我掌握情況**。」

Practice 93

> “The manager **kept the team informed** throughout the project.”

「經理在整個項目期間都**讓團隊掌握最新情況**。」

keep someone informed = 持續提供最新資料，使某人一直知道情況

48. **keep something in mind** (記住 / 考慮) — 記住；留意

A fixed expression overlapping with the **mind** family.

Practice 94

> “**Keep in mind** that the audience may be nervous too.”

「要**記住 / 留意**，觀眾也可能會緊張。」

Practice 95

> “I kept that advice ****in mind**** during the presentation.”

「簡報期間，我一直把那個建議****記在心裡****。」

****keep something in mind** = 持續記住某項資料，並在行動 / 判斷時加以考慮******

49. ****keep your distance** (保持距離) — 保持距離******

Practice 96

> “Please ****keep your distance**** from the equipment.”

「請跟設備****保持距離****。」

Practice 97

> “He preferred to ****keep his distance**** from office politics.”

「他比較喜歡****與辦公室政治保持距離 / 避免捲入****。」

****keep your distance** = 維持實際或比喻上的距離，不過分接近 / 介入******

50. ****keep someone/something out** (不讓進入) — 阻止進入******

A phrasal extension.

Practice 98

> “The door is designed to ****keep noise out****.”

「這道門的設計是為了****阻隔噪音進入****。」

Practice 99

> “Security kept unauthorized visitors ****out****.”

「保安人員****不讓未獲授權的訪客進入****。」

****keep someone/something out** = 阻止某人 / 某物進入某個地方******

51. **keeper = person who looks after something/someone (看守人 / 飼養員) — 看守人 ; 管理員 ; 飼養員**

A useful related noun.

Practice 100

> “The animal **keeper** checked the enclosure.”

「動物**飼養員**檢查了圍欄。」

Practice 101

> “The museum **keeper** looked after the collection.”

「博物館的**管理 / 看守人員**照料館藏。」

keeper = 負責照顧、管理、看守某人 / 某物的人

Exact Chinese depends heavily on context.

52. **goalkeeper / wicketkeeper (守門員 / 守門相關角色) — 守門員等**

Useful compounds.

Practice 102

> “The **goalkeeper** saved the shot.”

「**守門員**救出了那次射門。」

Practice 103

> “The **wicketkeeper** caught the ball.”

「板球的**守門員**接到了球。」

These are lexicalized compounds built on **keeper**, not separate senses of bare **keep**.

53. **a keeper = something/someone worth keeping (值得留下的人 / 物) — 值得保留的好東西 / 好對象**

An informal noun meaning.

Practice 104

> “This recipe is definitely a **keeper**.”

「這個食譜絕對是**值得保留下來再用的好食譜**。」

Practice 105

> “Everyone likes her—she’s a **keeper**.”

「大家都喜歡她，她真是個**值得珍惜 / 長期交往的人**。」

a keeper = 質素很好、值得長期保留 / 珍惜的人或物

Informal.

54. **for keeps** (永久地 / 玩真的) — 永久；認真的

A fixed informal expression.

Practice 106

> “You can have it **for keeps**.”

「這個你可以**永遠留著，不用歸還**。」

Practice 107

> “This time they are competing **for keeps**.”

「這次他們是**動真格 / 認真來的**。」

for keeps = 永久地，或表示某事情是真正認真、有實際後果的

Informal.

Important distinction: keep doing vs continue doing

These are very close.

keep doing

often suggests:

- * ongoing repetition;
- * persistence;
- * continuation despite circumstances.

> “She kept practising.”

= 她一直練習。

continue doing

is more neutral/formal:

> “She continued practising.”

= 她繼續練習。

For your sentence:

> **keep avoiding**

has a strong sense of:

一直反覆逃避下去

which fits the meaning very naturally.

Important distinction: **keep doing vs keep on doing**

Both mean continue.

keep doing

is the normal broad form.

keep on doing

can add emphasis on repetition/persistence:

> “He keeps on interrupting me.”

= 他不停打斷我。

Often slightly more expressive.

Important distinction: ****keep doing vs keep someone from doing****

These are almost opposite.

****keep doing****

= continue the action.

> “Keep speaking.”

= 繼續說。

****keep someone from doing****

= prevent the action.

> “Fear kept me from speaking.”

= 恐懼令我無法說話。

The word ****from**** completely changes the construction.

Important distinction: ****keep vs hold****

These overlap in some contexts.

****hold****

often means physically have/grip something:

> “Hold the microphone.”

****keep****

means continue to possess/store it:

> “Keep the microphone.”

= 把咪高峰留下 / 保留。

So:

****hold = 當下拿著****

****keep = 保留 / 繼續擁有****

Important distinction: **keep vs save**

**keep**

= retain/store something.

**save**

can mean:

- * preserve from harm;
- * store digital data;
- * reserve for later;
- * avoid spending.

Compare:

> “Keep this document.”

= 保留這份文件。

> “Save this document.”

= 儲存這份電子文件。

Context matters.

Important distinction: **keep vs store**

**keep**

is broad everyday English:

> “I keep the files here.”

store

focuses more specifically on placing something somewhere for later use:

> “The files are stored on a server.”

So:

keep = 保存 / 放著

store = 儲存 / 存放

Important distinction: **keep vs maintain**

keep

is everyday and flexible:

> “Keep the room clean.”

maintain

is more formal and often suggests sustained management/maintenance:

> “Maintain the equipment in good condition.”

Both can mean 維持, but register and collocation differ.

Important distinction: **keep calm vs stay calm**

These are very close.

keep calm

often emphasizes:

> maintain calmness despite pressure.

stay calm

= remain calm.

Both are natural:

> “Keep calm.”

> “Stay calm.”

The distinction is small.

Important distinction: **keep something safe vs protect something**

keep something safe

= maintain it in a safe condition.

protect something

= actively prevent harm/damage.

> “This case protects the device and keeps it safe.”

= 保護套防止損壞，令裝置保持安全。

Important distinction: **keep a promise vs make a promise**

make a promise

= first give the promise.

keep a promise

= later do what you promised.

> “She made a promise and kept it.”

= 她作出承諾並履行了。

Excellent collocation contrast.

Important distinction: ****keep a secret vs tell a secret****

****keep a secret****

= not reveal it.

****tell/reveal a secret****

= communicate it.

They describe opposite actions.

Important distinction: ****keep in touch vs stay in touch****

These are essentially equivalent:

> “Let’s keep in touch.”

> “Let’s stay in touch.”

Both:

「保持聯絡。」

Important distinction: ****keep track of vs follow****

****keep track of****

= continuously monitor/know changes, location, number, progress.

****follow****

can simply mean:

- * watch;
- * understand;
- * track developments.

****Keep track of**** strongly emphasizes maintaining an ongoing record/awareness.

Important distinction: **keep an eye on vs watch**

watch

= look at/observe something for a period.

keep an eye on

= monitor casually or take temporary responsibility.

> “Keep an eye on my bag.”

= 幫我看一下袋子。

It does not mean stare at it continuously.

Important distinction: **keep animals vs own animals**

own

= legally possess.

keep

= have and care for them over time.

Someone may **keep horses** even where legal ownership is not the main point.

Important distinction: **food keeps vs food lasts**

These can overlap.

food keeps

focuses on:

> remaining fresh/unspoiled.

food lasts

can mean:

> quantity is enough for a period.

Compare:

> “The cheese keeps for a week.”

= 芝士可保存一星期。

> “This food will last us a week.”

= 這些食物夠我們吃一星期。

Very different ideas.

Important distinction: **keeper vs owner**

keeper

= person who cares for/manages/guards something.

owner

= person who legally possesses it.

The keeper need not be the owner.

Important distinction: **a keeper vs keeper as job**

Job/person:

> “an animal keeper”

= 飼養員

Informal evaluation:

> “This recipe is a keeper.”

= 這個食譜值得保留。

Same noun, different sense.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **keep** family is extremely rich in continuation, possession, maintenance, prevention, observance, and fixed expressions:

- * **keep + -ing** = 一直 / 繼續做
- * **keep on + -ing** = 不停 / 持續做
- * **keep going** = 繼續下去 / 撐下去
- * **keep something** = 保留 / 留下
- * **keep something somewhere** = 存放
- * **keep food** = 保存食物
- * **keep a record** = 記錄 / 保存紀錄
- * **keep + adjective** = 保持某狀態
- * **keep something + adjective** = 令某物保持某狀態
- * **keep someone busy/interested** = 令某人一直處於某狀態
- * **keep something running** = 維持運作
- * **keep costs low/prices stable** = 維持某狀態
- * **keep someone waiting** = 讓某人一直等
- * **keep someone from doing** = 阻止某人做
- * **keep something from happening** = 防止事情發生
- * **keep away** = 遠離 / 避免
- * **keep to a schedule/rule** = 遵守
- * **keep to the point** = 緊扣重點
- * **keep a promise** = 信守承諾
- * **keep your word** = 守信
- * **keep a secret** = 保密
- * **keep in touch** = 保持聯絡
- * **keep track of** = 追蹤 / 掌握
- * **keep an eye on** = 留意 / 照看
- * **keep watch** = 看守 / 監察
- * **keep someone company** = 陪伴
- * **keep animals** = 飼養
- * **keep a shop/inn** = 經營 (較傳統)
- * **keep someone financially** = 供養 (較傳統)
- * **food keeps** = 保存良好、不變壞
- * **keep fit/healthy** = 保持健康
- * **keep warm/cool/dry** = 維持物理狀態
- * **keep left/right** = 靠左 / 右
- * **keep pace with** = 跟上步伐
- * **keep up with** = 跟上
- * **keep your balance** = 保持平衡
- * **keep control/order** = 維持控制 / 秩序
- * **keep your cool/head** = 保持冷靜
- * **keep an open mind** = 保持開放態度

* **keep someone informed** = 讓某人持續知情
 * **keep in mind** = 記住 / 考慮
 * **keep your distance** = 保持距離
 * **keep out** = 阻止進入
 * **keeper — caretaker** = 看守人 / 飼養員
 * **keeper — worth keeping** = 值得保留的人 / 物
 * **for keeps** = 永久地 / 認真的

The main semantic branches are:

> **continue**

> **retain / possess**

> **store / preserve**

> **maintain a state**

> **prevent / restrain**

> **observe / honour a rule or promise**

> **care for / watch**

plus many useful fixed expressions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
keep + -ing	某個動作持續、反覆或不停止地進行；一直 / 繼續做
keep on + -ing	持續不斷或反覆做某事，常帶較強的「不停」語氣
keep going	即使遇到困難、疲勞或出錯，仍繼續進行
keep something — retain	繼續擁有某物，不把它交走、丟掉、歸還或放棄
keep something somewhere	把某物放在指定地方保存，以便日後使用
keep food	以適當方式保存食物，使其不容易變壞
keep a record	建立並持續保存資料 / 紀錄
keep + adjective	讓自己持續處於某種狀態
keep something + adjective	使某人 / 某物持續維持指定狀態
keep someone busy/interested	令某人持續處於忙碌 / 有興趣等狀態
keep something running/working	令系統、機器或活動持續運作而不中斷
keep someone waiting	令某人持續處於等待狀態
keep someone from doing	阻止或妨礙某人進行某個動作
keep something from happening	防止某件事情發生

keep away from	不靠近 / 避免接觸某人、某物或某情況	
keep to a rule/schedule	按照既定規則、時間或計劃行事，不偏離	
keep to the point/topic	持續集中在相關內容，不離題	
keep a promise	按照自己已答應的內容行事；信守承諾	
keep your word	履行自己曾作出的承諾；說到做到	
keep a secret	不把秘密內容告訴其他人	
keep in touch	持續與某人聯絡，不失去聯繫	
keep track of	持續掌握某人 / 某事的位置、進度、數量或變化	
keep an eye on	持續留意、監察或暫時照看某人 / 某物	
keep watch	持續觀察某處 / 某人，以防問題發生	
keep someone company	留在某人身邊陪伴，使對方不用獨處	
keep animals	長期飼養並照顧動物	
keep a shop/inn	經營並管理商店 / 旅店；較傳統用法	
something keeps — food/product	某物在一段時間內仍保持良好 / 不變壞	
keep fit/healthy	持續維持良好的身體狀態	
keep left/right	持續位於指定方向 / 道路一側	
keep pace with	以相同速度或進度前進，不被對方拋離	
keep your balance	防止自己失去平衡	
keep control/order	持續掌握情況 / 防止混亂	
keep your cool/head	在壓力、憤怒或突發情況中仍維持冷靜理性	
keep an open mind	暫不過早下結論，願意考慮不同可能性 / 觀點	
keep someone informed	持續提供最新資料，使某人一直掌握情況	
keep something in mind	持續記住某項重要資訊並在判斷 / 行動時考慮	
keep your distance	維持實際或比喻上的距離，不過分接近 / 介入	
keeper — person	負責照顧、管理、看守某人 / 某物的人	
a keeper — informal	質素很好、值得長期保留 / 珍惜的人或物	
for keeps	永久地；或表示事情是認真的、有實際後果的	

For your original passage

Your passage uses **keep** twice in closely related ways:

> “I knew this was the kind of opportunity I could not **keep avoiding**.”

Here:

keep avoiding = 一直 / 持續逃避

The exact meaning is:

keep = 讓同一個行為反覆延續下去

Therefore:

> **could not keep avoiding**

= **「不能一直逃避下去」**

Later:

> “I did make a couple of small mistakes, but I **kept going** instead of freezing.”

Here:

keep going = 即使出錯，也沒有停止，而是繼續進行

Therefore:

> **I kept going**

= **「我繼續講下去 / 沒有停下來」**

These two uses are semantically connected:

> **keep avoiding**

> = 延緩一個你想停止的行為

> **keep going**

> = 延緩一個你想維持的行為

So the core passage mapping is:

keep + -ing = 持續 / 一直做某件事

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **keep practising**

> = 一直練習

> **keep going**

> = 繼續下去

> **keep the notes**

> = 把筆記留下 / 保留

> **keep the files here**

> = 把檔案存放在這裡

> **keep calm**

> = 保持冷靜

> **keep the slides simple**

> = 令投影片保持簡單

> **keep me waiting**

> = 讓我一直等

> **keep me from speaking**

> = 阻止我說話

> **keep a promise**

> = 信守承諾

> **keep a secret**

> = 保守秘密

> **keep in touch**

> = 保持聯絡

> **keep track of time**

> = 掌握時間

> **keep an eye on the clock**

> = 留意時鐘

> **keep someone company**

> = 陪伴某人

> **keep animals**

> = 飼養動物

> **a keeper**

> = 值得保留 / 珍惜的人或物

So **keep** is much richer than simply:

> **keep = 保持**

and in your original passage, its exact meaning is:

***“to continue doing the same action over time.”**